



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The most inexplicable thing happened!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you believe in aliens? Why or why not?
- Have you ever seen a movie about aliens? What happened?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences, strange events, and superstitions.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.
- I can talk about life experiences.





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about an alien encounter. Do you believe in **extraterrestrials***?

* "Extraterrestrial" is another word for alien.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I was reading up on alien encounters the other day. I came across this story from 1968. Mrs. Jones and her daughter, Alison, were driving down the highway early one morning when the most inexplicable thing happened. Mrs. Jones started to slow down because she saw a flashing light up ahead. She thought that it was an odd place for a traffic signal. Suddenly, a peculiar glow flooded the car with light. Then there was a thump and something was sucking the car upward! Needless to say, they were both feeling terrified as the car moved upward! Alison yelled and rolled up the window as gritty black powder started to seep into the car. Then came a horrible stench. It smelled disgusting. Mrs. Jones stepped down on the gas pedal. She raced to the nearest town, ran into the police station and reported the incident. The police were looking at her calmly and smiling. They thought that she had dreamt the whole thing.

They sat Mrs. Jones and her daughter down and brought them cups of tea. Meanwhile, the police heard from a local truck driver following the same route. He had also seen the bizarre light and complained about the black powder. Finally, the police decided to go out and take a look at the car. When they looked it over, they noticed dents in the roof. Peering in, they saw the black dust and when they opened the doors to get in they smelled the sickening odor. The story spread quickly. Mrs. Jones and her daughter were celebrities for a few days. Even today, this story is cited as proof that aliens visit earth.





Let's Practice!

How long will you take to *dig up all the phrasal verbs?

*"To dig up" means to find out about something after searching for information.

Instructions: Find the expressions in the wordsearch.

1. When you enter a place, you ...
2. When you are driving and you want to lose velocity, you ...
3. When you receive communication from someone, you ...
4. When something has become popular, you say ...
5. When you meet or find someone by chance, you ...

Y	F	J	U	F	M	M	Y	X	C	K	L	R	V	O
O	K	O	H	E	A	R	F	R	O	M	R	E	O	B
M	H	D	B	Q	Y	N	L	I	C	M	C	P	I	G
K	W	S	Y	I	C	E	P	X	Y	Q	U	Q	W	G
H	R	L	W	F	A	F	T	G	L	J	D	E	Y	M
C	H	O	E	X	T	U	O	L	C	E	L	D	N	B
P	U	W	Q	H	C	C	I	B	G	E	T	I	N	L
K	E	D	N	L	H	T	L	O	G	V	X	Z	Y	C
P	M	O	A	L	O	D	N	V	S	R	R	R	X	R
C	M	W	O	N	N	J	G	P	L	O	L	K	H	N
F	Z	N	R	R	S	V	A	E	N	G	C	X	Y	T
K	M	S	R	Q	B	D	G	L	P	A	B	O	R	N
Z	Z	W	I	C	O	M	E	A	C	R	O	S	S	B
L	C	T	P	R	Q	V	P	I	N	A	Q	N	W	E
S	Y	N	G	C	Q	U	A	O	G	G	Z	M	Z	X



Let's Practice!

Let's complete the outline of the story.

Instructions: Write the correct form of the verbs in brackets. Use Past simple and Past Perfect. Read the sentences aloud. Compare yourself to the audio.

1. She _____ (start) to slow down because she _____ (see) a light flashing on the road ahead.
2. Feeling terrified and out of control, the family _____ (notice) a black powder _____ (start) to seep inside their car.
3. In a state of shock, they _____ (drive) to the nearest town and _____ (report) the incident to the police.
4. Meanwhile, the police _____ (hear) from a local truck driver following the same route as Mrs. Jones - he _____ (see) the bizarre light in the distance too.
5. Finally, the police _____ (agree) to inspect the car. When they _____ (get in), they saw the dust and also _____ (notice) some small dents in the roof of the car.





Extension Activity

Watch a movie about an alien attack.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a movie about aliens (e.g., *Independence Day*, *Alien*, *Evolution*, *The Fourth Kind*)
- Watch the movie with English subtitles and take notes of new words and important events.
- Look up the new vocabulary words.
- Share your notes and discuss the movie with a partner.
- Retell the story of the movie to your partner (use past tenses).

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch a movie about aliens.

☐ ☐

I take notes about the main events and take notes of new vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I look up the new words and their definitions.

☐ ☐

I retell the story of the movie using my notes.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- encounter** (noun): a meeting that has not been planned
e.g. I was reading up on alien encounters the other day.
- inexplicable** (adjective): difficult or impossible to explain
e.g. He had a strange sense of fear that was inexplicable to him.
- peculiar** (adjective): strange; unfamiliar; a little surprising
e.g. Suddenly, a peculiar glow flooded the car with light.
- stench** (noun): a very strong and unpleasant smell
e.g. Then came a horrible stench. It smelled disgusting.
- to seep** (verb): to flow into or out of something through an opening
e.g. Alison yelped and rolled up the window as gritty black dust started to seep into the car.
- incident** (noun): an unusual event, often surprising or violent
e.g. She ran into the police station and reported the incident.
- bizarre** (adjective): strange; very unusual
e.g. He had also seen the bizarre light and complained about the black dust.
- dent** (noun): a hollow in the surface of something made by hitting it
e.g. When they looked the car over, they noticed dents in the roof.
- alien** (noun): an extraterrestrial
e.g. Even today, this story is cited as proof that aliens visit earth.





Learning Points

The Simple Past and Past Continuous Tenses

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous tenses together.

You can use the Past Continuous tense to refer to the context of a story. It talks about the 'background' action, or the longer action. You use it to talk about an action that was in progress in the past.

*I **was just reading** the latest edition of Mystery Magazine.
While **they were staying** in room 609 ...*

You can use the Simple Past tense to refer to a shorter action that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*A mother and daughter **died** in a fire ...
The owner **told** people they were there.*

Examples:

- Mrs. Jones and her daughter, Alison, were driving down the highway early one morning when the most inexplicable thing happened.
- The police were looking at her calmly and smiling.
- I was reading up on alien encounters the other day.

Inseparable Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are two-part verbs consisting of a verb followed by an adverb particle (these look like prepositions, but do not have the same function in phrasal verbs).

In some cases, you cannot separate the verb and the particle. These are called *inseparable* phrasal verbs.

It is important to remember that the meaning of a phrasal verb is often very different from the two parts taken separately.

For example:

Matt **turned up** last night (= appeared, not the same as turned + up).

To *turn up* is an inseparable phrasal verb. You cannot put an object between the verb and the particle. It must remain together.

Another example is *to get off*.

You can say "**get off** the bus", but you cannot say "**get** the bus **off**".

A few verbs can be used with both a particle and a preposition, making them **three-part**





Learning Points

verbs.

For example:

to run away with (to leave; to escape from)

to watch out for (to be careful for)

to back out of (to fail to keep a promise)

Learning phrasal verbs is a lot like learning new vocabulary. You must memorize which phrasal verbs are inseparable and learn their meanings.

Look at the chart for some more inseparable phrasal verbs and their meanings.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
<i>read up on</i>	search for information on
<i>come across</i>	find accidentally
<i>hear from</i>	receive communication from
<i>get in</i>	enter (a vehicle)
<i>hear of</i>	learn about (sometimes accidentally)

Examples:

- *I was reading up on alien encounters the other day.*
- *When they looked the car over, they noticed dents in the roof.*
- *Meanwhile, the police heard from a local truck driver following the same route.*
- *I came across this story.*
- *She ran away with a boy her parents hated.*

